

Generated from docs/handoff-guides/markdown/design/story.md by tools/guide-publisher .

Story Handoff Guide

Use this guide when you need to describe a **journey, process, use case, activity sequence, or business story**.

This guide is about **what happens, who is involved, what changes, and what outcome is reached**.

KNOWLEDGE AREA

This guide helps with **business journeys and scenarios**.

Guide family map

Where this guide sits in the full Blueprint Handoff Atlas family.

ROOT & CROSS-CUTTING

Handoff Atlas

Blueprint Bundle

Metamodel Vocabulary

Migrations

DESIGN

Architecture

Concepts

Domain

Dynamics

Infrastructure

Interactions

Models

Quality

Rules

Story

GOVERNANCE

Capability

Decisions

Motivation

Organization

Roadmap

Test Cases

Value Stream

Capture → focus → transformation

What to gather first, what this layer focuses on, and what a modeler or AI agent can produce from it.



What belongs here

Capture things like:

- a user journey
- a business process
- a service flow
- a use case
- a sequence of activities and steps
- success, error, and exception paths

What does not belong here

- full definitions of business concepts — put those in the Concepts guide
- detailed screen behavior — put that in the Interactions guide
- formal rules and constraints — describe them here only briefly and link them conceptually

Core things to capture

Describe:

- **who** starts the story
- **why** the story exists
- **what activities** happen
- **what steps** happen inside those activities
- **what triggers** the next part
- **what success looks like**
- **what can go wrong**
- **what other concepts, screens, or rules are involved**

Core relationships to capture

Make these links explicit in your text:

- actor -> story
- story -> activity
- activity -> step
- step -> next step or next activity
- story -> concepts involved
- story -> screens/interactions involved
- story -> outcomes, risks, or rules that matter

Modus operandi

When eliciting a story, work in this order:

1. name the **goal**
2. identify the **actor**
3. describe the **main happy path**
4. split the flow into **activities**
5. add important **steps** inside each activity
6. add **exceptions, errors, and alternate paths**
7. list the concepts and screens involved

Focus on the business meaning of the flow, not on technical implementation.

Prompt set

Use questions like these:

- who wants something to happen?
- what starts the flow?
- what is the first meaningful activity?
- what happens next, and why?
- what is the expected outcome?
- what can fail?
- what other people or systems take part?
- what business concepts are changed, read, or created?

Free-text intake template

Use this template when gathering notes:

- **Story name:**
- **Goal:**
- **Primary actor(s):**
- **Trigger:**
- **Main outcome:**
- **Activities:**
 - Activity 1:
 - purpose:
 - steps:
 - result:
 - Activity 2:
 - purpose:
 - steps:
 - result:
- **Error or alternate paths:**
- **Concepts involved:**
- **Screens or interactions involved:**
- **Important rules or risks:**

Worked example

Example: customer submits a return request

- **Goal:** a customer requests a return and receives a decision
- **Primary actor:** customer
- **Trigger:** customer decides to return an item from a completed order
- **Main outcome:** return request is approved or rejected
- **Activities:**
 - Create request
 - customer selects items and reason
 - system records the request
 - Review request
 - system checks policy and eligibility
 - system approves automatically or routes for manual review
 - Notify customer
 - system sends the decision
- **Error or alternate paths:**
 - request falls outside the allowed return window

- request is missing item selection
- request is rejected because the product is non-returnable
- **Concepts involved:** customer, order, return request, refund decision
- **Screens involved:** order details page, return request form, confirmation/decision screen

Layer-specific handoff guidance

For stories, the handoff should preserve the **narrative and outcome flow**.

The receiver should be able to tell:

- who wants what
- what the happy path is
- where the important exceptions are
- what concepts and screens the story touches

If the notes read like disconnected steps rather than one coherent journey, improve the handoff before transformation.

How this becomes YAML

A technical modeler or AI agent can transform this into a story layer by:

- turning the story into a named business narrative
- turning activities into ordered story activities
- mapping key steps to business operations
- linking actors, concepts, and screens
- separating happy path and error path behavior

You do not need to produce IDs or YAML field names yourself.

Common mistakes

- listing steps without the overall goal
- mixing several unrelated stories together
- describing only the happy path
- naming activities but not the result of each activity
- using UI button names instead of business actions

- forgetting which concepts are affected by the story

